



Mainstream Laptops

The masters of all trades

Mainstream laptops saw a rise in machines that promised more than just great performance. From 2-in-1 laptops that can transform into tablets to machines that came in exciting colour options, a lot happened this year. Under the hood, AI-centric processors promised maximum performance and better thermal management systems ensured that no laptops got “too hot to handle”.

Brands also shifted their focus to creating balanced machines that blend portability with real performance, giving students and working professionals far more for their money than ever before. Here is a look at the winners this year.

Zero1 Winner: Dell 14 Plus 2-in-1

The Dell 14 Plus 2-in-1 stands out as the most capable mainstream laptop this year, thanks to its performance, features and flexible form factor. Powered by Intel Core Ultra 7 processor, it breezed through our day-to-day testing and displayed strong scores across various benchmark tests like PCMark 10, Cinebench R23 and Geekbench 6.

The laptop's 14-inch 2K display is sharp and immersive, with great colour accuracy for casual users. The 360 degree hinge adds immense flexibility, and paired with the responsive Dell Pen, the laptop becomes a capable sketching and note-taking device whenever you want it to. Battery life easily lasts a full workday and thermals remain well controlled even under prolonged load. Despite limited ports and average speakers, the



Dell 14 Plus 2-in-1
Price: ₹1,01,189

overall package is unmatched in this segment, making the Dell 14 Plus 2-in-1 the clear Zero1 Winner for mainstream laptops.

Runner-up: HP Omnibook 3

The HP Omnibook 3 is the Runner Up this year for delivering a great performance in its price segment. With AMD's Ryzen AI 5340 processor and Radeon 840M graphics, it is quite reliable for everyday tasks. The laptop's 15.6-inch FHD display, comfortable keyboard and lightweight design make it suited for long hours of work or study.

Battery life is another highlight, often stretching close to ten hours in regular use, and fast charging keeps downtime short. HP's sustainability push also deserves credit, with the chassis incorporating recycled materials and earning top-tier environmental certifications. For users who want a balanced, dependable laptop, the Omnibook 3 is a sensible mainstream pick this year.



HP Omnibook 3
Price: ₹76,295

Best Buy: Asus Vivobook 16

The Snapdragon-powered Asus Vivobook 16 impressed us with its efficiency-first design and smooth everyday performance. Equipped with the Qualcomm Snapdragon X X1 26 100 processor, integrated Adreno graphics and a capable Hexagon NPU, it delivers excellent responsiveness for productivity workloads while keeping heat and power consumption firmly in check. Its 16-inch FHD+ display offers good viewing angles and a comfortable workspace.

Thus, the Vivobook 16 shines for those who want a large screen, good battery life and a quiet, cool experience.

— Divyanshi Sharma | editor@digit.in



Asus Vivobook 16
Price: ₹84,990